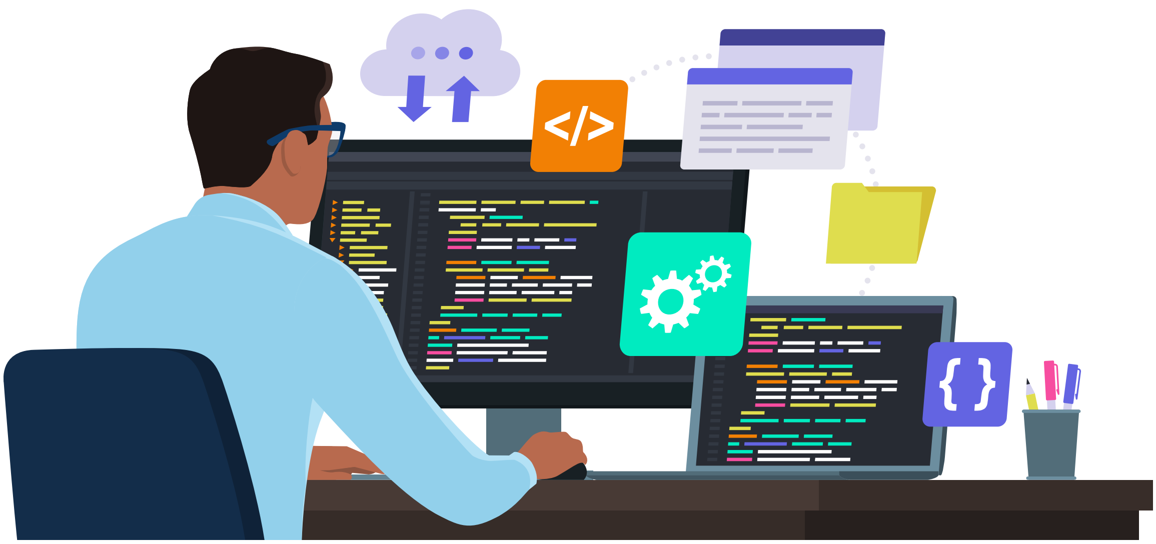
How to Measure and Track the Effectiveness of Software Features Deployed in a Production Environment

Software may require a new update or release due to the need for certain capability improvements or bug fixes. In this two-part series of articles, we look into the system and method for measuring and tracking the effectiveness of software features deployed in production environments.



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In a software release cycle, different types of capabilities or changes may be released to production, depending on the nature of the software, the development methodology (e.g., Agile, Waterfall) and the specific release goals. Some of the common types of capabilities are new features, user experience enhancements, bug fixes, performance/security improvements, localisation/internationalisation updates, etc. Of all these, in general, the delivery is generally around the introduction of new features, which can further be broadly classified into two different categories.

Features that are meant to solve customer problems: Customer-focused features are designed to enhance the user experience, address pain points, and provide solutions to the problems and needs of end users, thereby improving user satisfaction, attracting new customers, and retaining existing ones.

Features that are meant to solve business problems: Business-focused features related to data management, process automation, cost reduction, analytics, etc, may not always be visible to end users but are essential for the successful operation of the business and are aimed at improving the efficiency, productivity, and profitability of the organisation. or business.

The balance between customer-focused and business-focused features can vary depending on the software's purpose, the organisation's goals, and the stage of development. It's common for organisations to prioritise customer-facing features, as they directly impact user satisfaction and can help gain a competitive advantage. However, business-focused features are equally important for optimising internal operations, reducing costs, and ensuring the software's long-term sustainability.